

Edgar F. Codd

Larry Ellison based his company's first database system on a paper by the British computer scientist titled "A Relational Model of Data for Large Shared Data Banks"

Structured Query

Chris Chelliah, Senior Director and Chief Architect, Appliance and Strategic Solutions, Oracle Corporation, Asia Pacific Division on Oracle's latest offering — the Exadata range of flash database servers

Q How do Oracle products appeal to SMBs?

A Customers are free to choose between deploying Oracle on a non-DB machines. Besides, Oracle will assist in all possible ways in terms of financing. We also have several cloud-based configurations that will suit most SMBs. This way, SMBs don't have to purchase the whole software package, but can rather lease out the package. In fact, they can use Oracle software on conventional hardware and migrate to Exadata later.

Q What about recurring costs and updates? That's an additional cost.

A When a customer buys an Oracle product, they pay an annual support fee. This gives them access to any update released. Irrespective whether the customer bought 7i or 8i, each version update is made available to our customer by way of annual support fees.

Q Can they use x86 based systems as well?

A Customers can choose from any platform they want. The DB machine is an offering.

Q What's the advantage of using Exadata if a company already has Oracle database running?

A Exadata is all about consolidating your Oracle investment. Consider the different business units or departments in an organisation using unique databases for individual applications. With Exadata, you can have a single control centre across all verticals and share your resources at the same time. With support for the x86 platform, processing speed goes up with every passing release in accordance with

Moore's law. The Exadata range employs Sun FlashFire cards and delivers up to 50 GB per second of raw I/O bandwidth and up to 10,00,000 I/O operations per second. Exadata version 2 is the fastest and the only online transaction processing (OLTP) database machine in the world. In fact, there is no other database appliance from any of our competitors available in the market capable of OLTP workload. Even if you opt for a custom-built solution, it would cost you up to four times more. At the same investment, Exadata servers are four times faster.

Q With the recent acquisition of Sun, what is the future of MySQL? Can enterprises using MySQL implement Exadata servers?

A I would not be the right person to comment on the Sun acquisition, but if you go by what Larry Ellison commented, Oracle is here to promote what Sun has done. Exadata is an offering, and currently only supports Oracle database. If you're using Oracle in your organisation, you won't need any new skills or training, or resources. You are up and ready to go to production in about half an hour compared to days and at times even weeks by employing competitors' products.

Q Oracle has been regarded as a enterprise-driven company while Sun was viewed as a technology-driven company. Could you comment on the apprehension surrounding this acquisition?

A I would not agree to this. In fact, I would say the problems and concerns



are sowed by our competitors. If you go by our record for the past 30-odd years, we were the first to write an SQL-based database. We have actively been involved online, and were pivotal in pioneering grid computing. We have the largest market share in the business. Our customers wouldn't have come to us had we been different. To add, Oracle is based on standards-based computing. We lead the way in standards. Be it Java, XML or even web servers, Oracle has actively contributed towards their development. We have our Enterprise Linux platform and have been contributing majorly to Linux for over eight years. We adopted Apache and have been contributing towards it.

Q Would you continue contributing towards the open source community?

A Again, I would not be the right person to comment on the future. I may comment and things may turn out differently in the future. However, the track record that Oracle has just speaks for itself. **d**